

Executive Director Decision

2026/008/R

of 10 July 2026

issuing the following:

Issue 1 of the Certification Specifications for Flight Simulation Training Devices (FSTDs)

‘CS-FSTD, Issue 1’

‘Update of the flight simulation training device requirements’

THE EXECUTIVE DIRECTOR OF THE EUROPEAN UNION AVIATION SAFETY AGENCY (EASA),

Having regard to Regulation (EU) 2018/1139¹, and in particular Articles 76(3) and 104(3)(a) thereof,

Having regard to Commission Regulation (EU) No 1178/2011², and in particular point ORA.FSTD.205 of Annex VII (Part-ORA) thereto,

Whereas:

- (1) Certification specifications (CSs) are non-binding technical standards issued by EASA, which indicate the means to demonstrate compliance with Regulation (EU) 2018/1139 and with the delegated and implementing acts adopted on the basis thereof, and which are used by persons and organisations for the purpose of certification.
- (2) Detailed specifications (DSs) are non-binding standards issued by EASA for the purpose of implementing Regulation (EU) 2018/1139 and the delegated and implementing acts adopted on the basis thereof.
- (3) Acceptable means of compliance (AMC) are non-binding standards issued by EASA, which are used by persons and organisations to demonstrate compliance with Regulation (EU) 2018/1139 and with the delegated and implementing acts adopted on the basis thereof.

¹ Regulation (EU) 2018/1139 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 4 July 2018 on common rules in the field of civil aviation and establishing a European Union Aviation Safety Agency, and amending Regulations (EC) No 2111/2005, (EC) No 1008/2008, (EU) No 996/2010, (EU) No 376/2014 and Directives 2014/30/EU and 2014/53/EU of the European Parliament and of the Council, and repealing Regulations (EC) No 552/2004 and (EC) No 216/2008 of the European Parliament and of the Council and Council Regulation (EEC) No 3922/91 (OJ L 212, 22.8.2018, p. 1) (<http://data.europa.eu/eli/reg/2018/1139/oj>).

² Commission Regulation (EU) No 1178/2011 of 3 November 2011 laying down technical requirements and administrative procedures related to civil aviation aircrew pursuant to Regulation (EC) No 216/2008 of the European Parliament and of the Council (OJ L 311, 25.11.2011, p. 1) (<http://data.europa.eu/eli/reg/2011/1178/oj>).

- (4) Guidance material is non-binding material issued by EASA, which helps to illustrate the meaning of delegated or implementing acts or certification specifications (CSs) and detailed specifications (DSs), and which is used to support the interpretation of Regulation (EU) 2018/1139, of the delegated and implementing acts adopted on the basis thereof, and of CSs and DSs.
- (5) EASA shall, pursuant to Article 4(1)(a) of Regulation (EU) 2018/1139, reflect the state of the art and the best practices in the field of aviation and update its Decisions, taking into account worldwide aviation experience and scientific and technical progress in the respective fields.
- (6) The rise of new technologies in the pilot training domain makes it possible to reshape and optimise pilot training. With Regulation (EU) 2026/781³, amending Regulation (EU) No 1178/2011 and Regulation (EU) No 965/2012⁴ a new regulatory approach for qualification and use of flight simulation training devices (FSTDs) was introduced, based on the FSTD features and fidelity levels specified in the FSTD capability signature (FCS) and a task-to-tool concept for aeroplane and helicopter type rating training and operator recurrent training.
- (7) EASA determined the need to establish new standards for qualification of aeroplane and rotorcraft FSTDs, based on the FCS concept. These standards serve as the qualification basis for initial and subsequent evaluations of FSTDs with FCS.
- (8) EASA, pursuant to Article 115(1)(c) of Regulation (EU) 2018/1139 and Article 6 of the EASA Rulemaking Procedure⁵, widely consulted the interested parties on the content of this Decision, and provided thereafter a written response to the comments received through the consultation⁶,

HAS DECIDED:

Article 1

The Certification Specifications for Flight Simulation Training Devices (CS-FSTD) Issue 1 are laid down in the Annex to this Decision.

Article 2

This Decision shall enter into force on the day following that of its publication in the Official Publication of EASA.

³ Commission Implementing Regulation (EU) 2026/781 of 8 April 2026 amending Regulations (EU) No 1178/2011 and (EU) No 965/2012 as regards the requirements applicable to flight simulation training devices and the use of those devices for pilot training, testing and checking (OJ L, 2026/781, 10.4.2026, ELI: http://data.europa.eu/eli/reg_impl/2026/781/oj).

⁴ Commission Regulation (EU) No 965/2012 of 5 October 2012 laying down technical requirements and administrative procedures related to air operations pursuant to Regulation (EC) No 216/2008 of the European Parliament and of the Council (OJ L 296, 25.10.2012, pp. 1–148) ([Regulation - 965/2012 - EN - EUR-Lex](#)).

⁵ EASA is bound to follow a structured rulemaking process as required by Article 115(1) of Regulation (EU) 2018/1139. Such a process has been adopted by the EASA Management Board (MB) and is referred to as the 'Rulemaking Procedure'. See MB Decision No 01-2022 of 2 May 2022 on the procedure to be applied by EASA for the issuing of opinions, certification specifications and other detailed specifications, acceptable means of compliance and guidance material ('Rulemaking Procedure'), and repealing Management Board Decision No 18-2015 ([EASA MB Decision No 01-2022 on the Rulemaking Procedure, repealing MB Decision 18-2015 \(by written procedure\) | EASA \(europa.eu\)](#)).

⁶ Comments received during the development of CS-FSTD issue 1



It shall apply from 30 April 2028.

Cologne, 10 July 2026

For the European Union Aviation Safety Agency

The Executive Director

Florian GUILLERMET

